

# MWM Authenticated Production Audit: Reviewer Report

**Date:** August 8, 2026

**Auditor:** Manus AI (Authenticated Audit)

**Account:** Apple Reviewer (Trailblazer Tier, Trust Level 5, Washington DC)

## 1. Executive Summary

The authenticated production audit of Mapping With Melanin™ reveals a platform with a **compelling cultural vision** and high-quality core content (specifically HBCU and cultural landmark data), but one that is currently struggling with **material feature gaps** and a significant reliance on **fabricated placeholder data** presented as production inventory.

While the login experience is smooth and the account provisioning is accurate, the transition from "Marketing" to "Member" is broken. Authenticated users are frequently served waitlist-oriented marketing pages instead of functional tools. The **Kinfolk AI** is the platform's standout feature, delivering culturally fluent and context-aware responses, though it currently lacks integration with the app's own business database.

The most critical risks for Apple App Store approval are the **fabricated business and safety metrics** (P0) and the **non-functional core discovery filters** (P0/P1).

## 2. Ranked Findings

| Priority | Category            | Issue Description                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| P0       | Trust & Credibility | <b>Fabricated Production Data:</b><br>The /businesses and /safety pages are populated with invented businesses and safety scores (e.g., "8,393 reviews" for cities) that do not exist in the database. |
| P0       | UX / Logic          | <b>Post-Login Landing:</b><br>Authenticated users are redirected to the marketing homepage and asked to "Join the Waitlist," creating a "dead-end" experience for new members.                         |

|    |              |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| P0 | Core Feature | <b>Diversity Badging:</b> Ownership badges (e.g., "Verified Black-Owned") only appear for Black-owned businesses. Hispanic, Dominican, and other minority designations are invisible in the UI. |
| P1 | Discovery    | <b>Broken Map Filters:</b> Map legend chips act as exclusive selectors rather than additive layers. Turning off "Public Art" wipes ~90% of all other pins.                                      |
| P1 | Content      | <b>Missing Detail Pages:</b> All 101 HBCUs and ~2,900 cultural sites have no in-app detail pages. "Learn More" sends users off-platform to external websites.                                   |
| P1 | Data Quality | <b>Geocoding Errors:</b> Seeded businesses like "Angie's Eats" have no street address, causing map pins to center on city centroids rather than actual locations.                               |
| P2 | Branding     | <b>Product Naming:</b> User-facing copy on business pages refers to the app as "Melanin Maps" instead of the trademarked "Mapping With Melanin™."                                               |
| P2 | AI / Safety  | <b>Policing Bias:</b> Kinfolk AI describes neighborhoods as "well-patrolled," contradicting the founder's rule against using policing as a safety metric.                                       |

## 3. Detailed Audit by Feature

### 3.1 Login & Onboarding

The login process is technically sound but leads to a poor user experience. The account was correctly identified as a **Trailblazer** tier with a **Trust Level 5**, yet the platform fails to

acknowledge this status upon entry.

- **Login Speed:** Excellent (3-6 seconds).
- **Redirect Logic: FAILED.** Redirects to the marketing homepage ( / ) instead of a member dashboard or the map.
- **Waitlist Wall:** Authenticated members are still shown "Join the Waitlist" forms and leaderboard prompts.

### 3.2 Map & Discovery (/map)

The map is the primary functional surface, but it suffers from centering bugs and interaction friction.

- **Centering: FAILED.** The map ignores the user's home city (Washington DC) and defaults to Philadelphia.
- **Inventory:** The map contains only **10 real businesses**, despite marketing claims of "124+."
- **Marker Interaction:** Hit targets are too small. Tapping a pin often results in a map pan rather than opening the business InfoWindow.
- **Layer Toggles:** Semantically broken. Toggles are exclusive (last-clicked-wins) and do not support additive viewing of different pin types.

### 3.3 Businesses & Detail Pages

There is a stark contrast between the **marketing placeholders** on /businesses and the **real seeded businesses** in the database.

| Business Name    | Ownership (UI)       | Ownership (API)         | Vibe Tags           |
|------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|---------------------|
| The Nail Jawns   | Verified Black-Owned | Black-Owned             | Generic / Hardcoded |
| Angie's Eats     | None                 | Latino / Hispanic-Owned | Generic / Hardcoded |
| ISSAAESTHETICS   | None                 | Dominican-Owned         | Generic / Hardcoded |
| Cherished Beauty | Verified Black-Owned | Black-Owned             | Generic / Hardcoded |

**Critical Note:** The "Community Vibes" tags are currently hardcoded and identical for every business. The AI-authored, culturally-specific vibes stored in the database (e.g., "Auntie Energy" for Angie's Eats) are not being surfaced to users.

### 3.4 Kinfolk AI™ (/travel)

Kinfolk AI is the most polished feature and successfully adopts a "Community Companion" persona.

- **Greeting:** Correctly uses "Let's map it out" and avoids "Plan your trip" language.
- **Context Awareness:** The launcher copy changes based on the page (e.g., "I'm here if you need me" on the Safety page).
- **Response Quality:** High. Recommendations like the **Odunde Festival** are culturally accurate and specific.
- **Grounding Issue:** The AI does not recommend MWM's own businesses. It recommends external spots, missing a key opportunity to drive traffic to member businesses.

### 3.5 Safety & Community

These pages are currently "feature-ghosts"—they describe functionality that does not yet exist.

- **Safety Scores:** The scores for cities (e.g., Atlanta 9.4) are **fabricated**. There is no way for a user to actually submit a safety report or incident alert.
  - **Community Groups:** The groups shown (e.g., "Solo Minority Travelers") are invented. Clicking "Join Group" redirects logged-in users back to the login page.
  - **Events:** Only one event exists in the system (Houston), while the map shows hundreds of "Festival" pins that are not listed on the Events page.
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## 4. Technical & API Audit

- **Data Integrity:** The `saved-places` API returns orphaned integer IDs (e.g., "41", "49") that do not match the UUIDs used for real businesses.
  - **Performance:** The `/api/cultural-sites` endpoint returns a massive 2.2MB payload in a single request. This will cause significant lag and data costs on mobile devices.
  - **Security:** The Google Maps API key is exposed without apparent HTTP referrer restrictions.
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## 5. Strategic Recommendations

1. **Ground Kinfolk AI:** Force the AI to prioritize MWM-listed businesses in its recommendations.

2. **Normalize Cultural Data:** Consolidate the duplicate categories (e.g., HBCU vs hbcu\_district ) to make the map filters functional.
3. **Implement Cultural Detail Pages:** The HBCU visit-tips are excellent; they need a dedicated page to live on so users can save them and add their own stories.
4. **Fix Diversity Visibility:** Update the UI to render badges for all ownership designations (Hispanic, Dominican, Indigenous, etc.), not just Black-owned businesses.
5. **Clean the "Waitlist" from Auth State:** Once a user is logged in, all "Join Waitlist" and "Sign Up" CTAs should be replaced with "Explore" or "Contribute."

**Audit Verdict:** The platform has a "Kinfolk" soul but a "Placeholder" body. To pass Apple Review and gain community trust, the fabricated data must be replaced with the real, high-quality cultural content already present in the database.